Arkham Horror: The Card Game

The Still Hour
Campaign Guide

A campaign for 1–4 investigators, best with 3.

How to Use This Guide

This guide is read as you play. **Do not read ahead.** It tells you when to read each section: the Prologue first, then the loop, then the districts as you reach them. Story text in boxes is read aloud. Everything after a **"Do not read until..."** line stays unread until the guide sends you there: it always starts on a fresh page, so you never glimpse it by accident. Use the contents on this page to find a section.

Some scenario boxes also hold story and resolution cards (First Dark, The Last Hour's resolutions and others) for reading at the table. This guide prints the same text; if they ever differ, the guide governs.

The guide will ask you to **make choices**; **The Districts** says how to record them. Every one returns later in the story.

Contents

How to Use This Guide	1
New Rules	2
Campaign Rules	3
Difficulty and Player Count	5
Campaign Setup	6
The Ambergrove Map	7
Prologue — The First Hour	8
The Loop	12
Between Loops	14
The Districts	19
The Lighthouse	20
The Drowned Church	22
The Sunken Road	24
The Square	26
The Fairground	28
The Almanac House	30
Finale — The Last Hour	32
Appendix — Starting Decks	37
Appendix — Encounter Deck Contents	38
Campaign Log	39

New Rules

Read this aloud before the Prologue. It is the whole idea in plain terms. **Campaign Rules**, after it, is a reference: check it when a question comes up, do not read it through. Everything else works as in the Arkham Horror: The Card Game Rules Reference.

One night, played again and again. You play the Prologue once, then the same night over and over. Each play-through is a **loop**. When a loop ends the board is cleared and it is eleven o'clock in the Square again. Three things carry over: your **Campaign Log**, your shared **banked Memory** and each investigator's **Years**.

The Hourglass is the clock. The agenda deck is nine **Hours**. Each Mythos phase from the second round places 1 doom on the current Hour, so an Hour passes about every second round. When the ninth Hour arrives, the loop ends. Each time an Hour passes, each investigator heals 1 damage and 1 horror.

The town is split into districts. The Square is always in play. Each loop you choose which other districts to visit and lay them out from their boxes. Crossing between districts costs time: the first crossing along each connection each round places 1 doom on the current Hour. You will usually finish work in two or three districts, so choosing where to go is your biggest decision: choose one path each loop and follow it through. Each district has an act deck: a first objective you can finish from the start, a second, deeper one that opens in Part II, and a last one that readies you for the finale.

Dissonance is how much the night has noticed you. It is one shared number from 0 to 24 that changes only when an effect says so. Each loop starts it at the number of loops you have completed, up to 6.

Band	Dissonance	What changes
Calm	0–7	Echo enemies are Sleepwalking (harmless).
Glitch	8–15	1 Static token joins the chaos bag. Echoes wake. The Appointed draws closer.
Noticed	16–23	2 Static tokens. The Appointed arrives. Each investigator gains 1 extra Year at the reset.
Reset	24	The loop ends at once.

The **Static token** is a new chaos token: **−3, and raise Dissonance by 1**.

The Appointed cannot be defeated, only held back. It climbs toward you as Dissonance and the Hours rise, and it hunts whoever carries the most Memory on their cards. An investigator at its location can **Hold Back** it: a success pushes it back a stage and rewinds the Hourglass by 1 Hour (the rewind at most 3 times a loop).

Memory is your experience. During a loop you gain Memory tokens on your cards. At the reset they go into one shared pool, **banked Memory**, which you spend between loops on **Recollections** (cards that remember the loop) and upgrades. Carrying Memory also makes you the one being hunted.

Years are the price. No one suffers trauma or dies. Each reset, each investigator gains **1 Year**, and more if they were defeated, if the loop ended in the Noticed band, or if they leaned heavily on the loop's powers. Years move you through four age brackets; each after the first changes your skills a little. At **18 Years** an investigator ages out.

Knowledge is what you learn. Finishing a district's act records **Knowledge** in your Campaign Log. It changes the town for good and pays banked Memory. Recording three surface entries, or completing Loop 3, begins **Part II**. The right deep entries open the way to end the night: **The Last Hour**.

The Control token keeps the numbers. Click its buttons whenever an effect changes what they track; hover over a button to see when. Your **Campaign Log** keeps the choices you make. If anything is unclear, this guide wins.

Campaign Rules

A reference. Look a rule up when a question comes up; **New Rules** is enough to start. These rules add to the Arkham Horror: The Card Game Rules Reference and win where they disagree. Numbers are for **three investigators**; **Difficulty and Player Count** gives the others, and the Control token applies them.

Loops. A loop runs from Loop Setup until it ends, at once, when the Hourglass reaches **Hour IX** (unless you begin the finale; see **The Last Hour**), when every investigator has been defeated or has resigned, or when Dissonance reaches the **reset value** (24). On cards, "scenario" and "game" mean the current loop and "interlude" means **Between Loops**; during the Prologue, "loop" means the Prologue. "Limit/Max once per loop" lasts until the loop ends. As in the Rules Reference, a limit is per investigator unless it says "group limit", and "Max" counts every copy for all investigators.

The reset. When a loop ends, read its resolutions, then **Between Loops**. Every card the boxes laid out, and every token on those cards, leaves the table, and every Static token leaves the chaos bag; then the scar's band puts back its own. The Hourglass returns to Hour I, the Appointed to Unseen, and Dissonance to the **scar**: the number of loops completed, maximum 6. Banked Memory, the Campaign Log and Years carry forward. Within a loop nothing resets when you travel between districts.

Defeat and resigning. No one suffers trauma or dies. A defeated investigator is eliminated for the rest of the loop and pays in Years (see **Years**); the Memory on their cards is still banked (the Control token keeps their count). An investigator leaves the campaign only by aging out, or in the finale. The hub Square has "➠: Resign." Resigning eliminates you for the loop but is not a defeat, and your Memory is still banked. There is no resigning in the Prologue or the finale. **Ending a loop early:** a loop runs to Hour IX even when its acts are done. Plan on one or two acts a loop; once yours are done, every investigator can resign at the Square and the loop ends at once (Loop Resolution 3), with the usual reset Years. Resign only when you are finished: you cannot return to the night.

Story assets. Some acts let you take a set-aside **story asset** (an asset with an encounter-card back) with an ➠ and carry it to another location. It has no cost or slot, cannot be discarded or given away, and leaves the game when its act advances. If its controller is eliminated, it is placed at their location, and any investigator there may take it with the ➠ on its card. When the finale begins, set aside each story asset in play or at a location; at the reset it returns to its box.

Parts of the campaign. The campaign has three parts. They are not act cards.

- **Part I — Learning the Rules.** It begins when your log records **You Are Unstuck**. Only each district's first objective (act 1a) can be completed.
- **Part II — The Shape of the Hour.** It begins at **Between Loops** step 5. Each district's second objective (act 2a) opens, and its last (act 3a) after it; the Appointed's Whispers join the encounter deck, and the Named enter the night.
- **The Last Hour.** The finale, once your Campaign Log records **The Way the Night Breaks**.

The Hourglass. The Hours (I–IX) are the agenda deck; "the Hourglass" is that deck and the current Hour is the current agenda. Hour I has a doom threshold of 3, Hours II–VIII of 2. From the second round on, the Mythos phase places 1 doom on the current Hour (step 1.2) and then checks the doom in play against its threshold (step 1.3), as the Rules Reference counts it.

- **Place X doom on the current Hour** (crossings and small costs of time): its threshold is checked only in the Mythos phase.
- **Advance the Hourglass by X Hours** (a **Skip**, as is any effect that advances it): one Hour at a time, turn the current Hour over and read its back, set it aside in order beside the Hours deck, and make the next Hour current. Never past Hour IX. (Click **Hour** on the Control token once per Hour: it moves the Hours on the table for you.)
- **The Hour turns.** Whenever the Hourglass advances or rewinds, remove all doom in play. Each time it advances to a new Hour (by doom or a Skip, not a canceled advance), each investigator heals 1 damage and 1 horror, and that Hour's "Forced – When the Hourglass advances to this Hour" resolves (in order during a Skip of several Hours, and again if the Hour is reached again after a rewind).
- **Rewind X Hours:** X times, put the current Hour back on the Hours deck and make the last Hour set aside current again, with no doom on it. No Forced ability resolves, and effects an Hour already created do not end. Never before Hour I. (Right-click **Hour** once per Hour: the Hours on the table follow.)
- **Cancel an advance:** cancel all of it; the current Hour stays, with its doom removed.

Districts and travel. Each of the six **districts** is a cluster of locations laid out from its own box; **The Square** is the hub. The district connections are The Square–The Nave, –The Milestones, –The Ticket Booth and –The Reading Room. The first time in a round that any investigator moves along a given district connection (either direction, by any means), place 1 doom on the current Hour after that move; later moves along it that round are free. A move not along a connection, or one that says it places no doom, costs no time and is not that first move. Enemy moves never cost time. Connection symbols match by shape **and** color. The only other link between districts, The Turning–The Winding Stair (the Lighthouse at the end of the Sunken Road), never places doom. **Fast routes:** The Low Bridge and The Winding Stair each have a fast route to and from The Square: as an ➠, raise Dissonance by 1 and move straight there. It is not along a connection, so it places no doom. (*The Crossing*, a Square encounter card, only shares the word.)

Dissonance. One shared value from 0 to the reset value (24). The reset sets it to the scar (that is not entering a band); otherwise it changes only when an effect says to **raise** or **lower** it.

Band	Dissonance	While in this band	On entering this band
Calm	0–7	No band Static tokens. Echoes are Sleepwalking.	—
Glitch	8–15	1 band Static token in the chaos bag.	The Approach advances to at least Sensed.
Noticed	16–23	2 band Static tokens in the chaos bag.	The Approach advances to Arrived.
Reset	24	—	The loop ends at once, even during a skill test or the finale.

Band changes apply at once. Static tokens added by cards are extra to the band's. Lowering Dissonance never pushes the Approach back.

The Static token. A symbol token: **−3. Raise Dissonance by 1.** It resolves when revealed during a skill test and returns to the bag afterward. Canceled, it has no modifier and no effect; sealed, it still counts toward its band. (Number tokens show only a modifier; every other chaos token, the Static token included, is a symbol token.)

Echoes and Sleepwalking. An Echo is an enemy with the Echo trait and the printed keyword **Sleepwalking**, which applies only while Dissonance is Calm unless a card says otherwise. A Sleepwalking enemy cannot engage or be engaged, attack or move, and cannot be attacked, evaded, dealt damage or targeted by card abilities; it is still an enemy in play. If it would spawn engaged, it spawns unengaged at that investigator's location; if it falls asleep while engaged, it disengages and stays. An Echo that **wakes** is exhausted (it readies in the upkeep phase as usual).

The Appointed. Its **Approach** runs Unseen, Sensed, Emerging, Arrived. To **advance** it means to raise it, never lower it; to **push it back** means to lower it 1 stage, never below Unseen. When the Approach becomes Sensed or later while the Appointed is set aside, it **manifests** at the revealed location farthest from all investigators that is not closed (the lead investigator breaks ties); pushed back to Unseen, it is set aside. It cannot be defeated. **Hold Back** is an ➤➤ on its card, only at its location and only while it is ready; a success exhausts it, so it can be held back once per round at most. A "Hold Back success" means succeeding at its test, or resolving it without a test when a card allows. **The Appointed's Approach**, in play beside the Hours deck in every loop and the finale, gives its behavior at each stage.

Memory. Memory on cards is Memory tokens on investigator and asset cards you control; "most Memory" means this (Stolen Minute's charges are not Memory). **Banked Memory** is one pool the party shares; "each investigator gains X banked Memory" adds X per investigator, and it never drops below 0. At the reset all Memory on cards, defeated investigators' included, is banked (except that of an investigator who ages out). Between loops you spend it as experience, except:

You buy	It costs
A Recollection	its printed Memory, nothing more (it is level 0)
An upgrade	the new card's level, with no credit for the card it replaces
Any other new level 0 card	1

So jump, don't climb: level 0 to 2 to 4 costs 6, level 0 straight to 4 costs 4. Each copy is bought separately, and the table decides how the shared pool is split. Decks keep their size: an upgrade replaces its base copy, and any other purchase replaces a card you remove (permanent cards, such as Anchor Point, are outside deck size and replace nothing). After spending, reduce banked Memory to **10 per investigator** (30 at three) if it is higher. Experience-cost rules apply to Memory: an exceptional card costs twice, a myriad card's extra copies are free, each customizable checkbox costs 1, and the current taboo list applies.

Recollections are bought between loops, never part of a starting deck (signature Recollections excepted). The **Recollections** pouch holds two of each, the most one deck may hold (Anchor Point: one); take each copy you buy from it, or copy one in Tabletop Simulator (hover, **Ctrl+C**, **Ctrl+V**).

Recollection	Card type	Memory
Foreknowledge	Skill	2
Muscle Memory	Skill	2
The Same Doorway Twice	Event	2
Rehearsed Escape	Event	2
The Long Way Round	Event	2
This Time For Sure	Event	2
Stolen Minute	Asset	3
Cassandra's Notebook	Asset	3
Anchor Point	Asset (permanent)	4
The Hour I Learned Your Name	Event	5

Cards from other campaigns. Investigators never earn experience (banked Memory and Victory replace it), so cards that gain experience (Ascetic, In the Thick of It, The Great Work, Charon's Obol and the like) do nothing: leave them out. Cards that need another campaign's records (Researched cards, and the Untranslated and Unidentified cards that write them) cannot be used. An exiled card leaves your deck until you buy it again at its normal Memory cost. A card that would give trauma gives none and otherwise works as printed; a card that defeats you, or costs being defeated, works as printed.

Knowledge. Completing a district's act records a **Knowledge** entry in your Campaign Log. It belongs to the party and changes the night from then on; its lasting effect is printed on the log beside it. Entries from acts 1a are **surface** entries, from acts 2a **deep** entries. Knowledge is never bought, only found. "Your Campaign Log records X" means X is written on the log; "you completed <act> this loop" means that act advanced this loop.

- **Knowledge pays Memory** the first time your log records an entry: each investigator gains **1** banked Memory for a surface entry and **3** for a deep one (counted at that moment's investigators). The Prologue's entry and The Way the Night Breaks pay nothing.
- **The Way the Night Breaks** is recorded together with The Appointed's Name, whose act needs What the Almanac Hid and The Vote That Never Ends. If The Appointed's Name or The Vote That Never Ends is later unticked, untick it too. The Control token tells you when to record it.
- **Seraphine's thread** (unheard, suspected or known) starts unheard; The Vote That Never Ends and The Appointed's Name say when to mark it, by where Seraphine is when they advance, and a mark never goes back. A Seraphine who joins later starts unheard. It only changes one line of the epilogue.

Years. At each reset, each investigator gains Years:

Why	Years
The loop ended	1
They were defeated during the loop	+1
The loop ended in the Noticed band or higher (16+)	+1
They leaned on the loop: paid "raise Dissonance" as a cost 3 or more times, or removed 4 or more Memory from their own cards for their own cards and abilities (such as Foreknowledge)	+1

Years that a card or resolution gives (A Year in a Night, the Hall of Mirrors, the ninth line, the name) are recorded at once with **Years**

pending and added at **Between Loops** step 1. The Records Office can take back one Year a card gave this loop. Years set an age bracket; a higher bracket replaces the lower, changes apply only Between Loops, and skills, maximum health and maximum sanity never drop below 1.

Bracket	Years	Change
Prime	0–4	None.
Weathered	5–9	The first time an investigator reaches Weathered or later, choose and lock −1 or −1, and +1 or +1 (the Interlude panel's skill buttons).
Elder	10–14	The Weathered changes, +1 more to the same mental skill, −1 maximum health, and 1 Memory on the investigator card at the start of each loop.
Ancient	15+	The Elder changes and −1 maximum sanity.

An investigator whose Years reach **18** at Between Loops step 1 ages out at once and does not play the next loop. The first time anyone ages out, add 1 to the chaos bag for the rest of the campaign. Their player may begin the next loop with a new investigator not yet used (0 Years, a new level 0 deck, no Recollections, purchases from the next Between Loops; they take the log panel of the investigator they replace), or the party continues without them: set **Investigators** on the Control token. If no investigator can continue, the campaign ends; see **Age stories**. For finale conditions and the epilogue, a bracket counts every Year, including those gained during that loop and the finale.

Victory. Each **Victory X** pays once per campaign: when you defeat an enemy with Victory X (a **Named** enemy from Part II, or one of a few optional monsters), or a loop ends with a Victory X location in play, revealed and with no clues, record its name on your Campaign Log's Victory list if it is not there, and each investigator gains X banked Memory. A defeated Victory enemy goes to the victory display for the rest of the loop and can be met again later without paying again. A Named enemy that a district's act 2a spawns appears only while that act is current, so defeat it before completing the act if you want its Victory.

Campaign chaos-bag changes. Some results add or remove a , or token for the rest of the campaign, on top of your difficulty's tokens; remove one only if it is in the bag. If you built the bag with the Control token's difficulty buttons, the token makes every change and says so in the chat; otherwise make each change by hand and note it on your log. Three are public: Part II begins, add 1 ; the first loop marked **Torn**, add 1 ; the first investigator to age out, add 1 .

Locations. Many locations trade one currency (time, Dissonance, a clue, a Year) for another; a few have a hazard that stops once your log records that district's Knowledge. A location that enters play revealed, or is revealed by an effect (a closed location opening, the Belfry at Hour III), gets clues equal to its clue value unless the effect says otherwise; flipping a location to its other side (its calm side) never adds clues. A **closed** location is unrevealed, has no clues and connects to nothing: nothing moves into it, spawns or manifests there; when it opens, it is revealed and gets its clues. (The Sealed Study keeps its name; "seal" in the Rules Reference applies only to chaos tokens.) Nothing can move into an **impassable** location; anything already there stays unless told to move.

Personal quest cards. Each investigator starts with one **Permanent** quest card, among the cards listed on the back of their investigator card. Its front names a quest and a **tally** kept across the campaign. When the tally reaches the goal, swap it for its bonded unlocked card from your investigator's pouch and tick **met** in your panel on page 1 of the Campaign Log. The unlocked card carries what ties your investigator to this campaign, such as the **Memory** they place on themselves, and a few clauses that use the campaign's trackers (Dissonance, the Hourglass, Knowledge); none of it applies until you swap. Investigator cards, signatures and weaknesses never need the campaign's trackers.

The Control token keeps the books: the Hour, Dissonance and its Static tokens, the Appointed's stage, Memory, Years and aging. Hover over any of its buttons, or the ones it puts on investigator cards, the Appointed and drawn Static tokens, to see when to click each one. Click whenever an effect changes what a button tracks, and do not also apply by hand what it applies. Right-click the token to turn this guide to a section.

Difficulty and Player Count

- **3 investigators:** every value as printed (Dissonance bands at 8 / 16, reset at 24, Memory cap 30, scar cap 6).
- **2 or 4 investigators:** the reset comes at **8 × investigators**; the Glitch band starts at one-third of the reset and the Noticed band at two-thirds (rounded down: 5 / 10 at two, 10 / 21 at four). The Memory cap is **10 × investigators**, and the scar cap is **2 × investigators**. With **2 investigators**, each gets **+2 maximum health** and **+2 maximum sanity** (the Control token shows them).
- **1 investigator:** use the two-investigator bands: the reset comes at **16**, the Noticed band at **10** and Glitch at **5**; the scar cap is **4**. The Memory cap is **10**. Your investigator gets **+3 maximum health** and **+3 maximum sanity** (the Control token shows the new maximums on their card). **Second wind:** once each loop (and once in the finale), when your investigator would be defeated, they are not: remove all damage and horror from them, and they gain **1 Year** (click **Years pending**). **In the finale:** each form of the Appointed gets **−1 fight** and **−1 evade**, and a fallen form rewinds the Hourglass by **2** Hours instead of 1.
- Values given "per investigator" (the finale's Memory thresholds and the health of the forms of the Appointed) scale on their own.
- The Control token applies all of these for you.
- The campaign is tuned for about 6–8 loops.

Campaign Setup

1. **Choose investigators.** The campaign is tuned for 3; it scales from 1 to 4.
2. **Seat the investigators.** On the Control token, click **Set Up Prologue** (or **Setup**): the Setup panel lists the investigators. Click each one you are playing, then **Seat investigators**. Each is seated on a free SCED playmat with their investigator card, minicard and personal quest card (see **Personal quest cards**), and a shuffled starting deck: the cards their back requires, the level 0 deck from **Appendix — Starting Decks** (out of SCED's player cards) and 1 random basic weakness. The Control token's per-investigator rows (Memory, Age) and the buttons on each investigator card (including **Quest**) appear, the party size is set and the log's page 1 fills in the investigators. *To play your own deck instead,* build a deck of level 0 cards under the investigator's deckbuilding rules (Recollections and upgrades are bought later, between loops), take the investigator card and the cards their back lists from that investigator's pouch (one per investigator, named for them), put the investigator card on a playmat and the deck on its Deck spot; the Setup panel then shows them as seated.
3. **Choose a difficulty.** On the Control token, click your difficulty's button (**Easy**, **Standard**, **Hard** or **Expert**): it fills SCED's chaos bag with the tokens below, plus any campaign chaos-bag changes so far (see **Campaign chaos-bag changes**). Without SCED, build the bag by hand.

Difficulty	Chaos tokens
Easy	+1, +1, 0, 0, 0, −1, −1, −1, −2, −2, 💀, 💀, ⚠, ◐, ✪2, 🐞, ✶
Standard	+1, 0, 0, −1, −1, −1, −2, −2, −3, −4, 💀, 💀, ⚠, ◐, ✪2, 🐞, ✶
Hard	0, 0, 0, −1, −1, −2, −2, −3, −3, −4, −5, 💀, 💀, ⚠, ◐, ✪2, 🐞, ✶
Expert	0, −1, −1, −2, −2, −3, −3, −4, −4, −5, −6, −8, 💀, 💀, ⚠, ◐, ✪2, 🐞, ✶

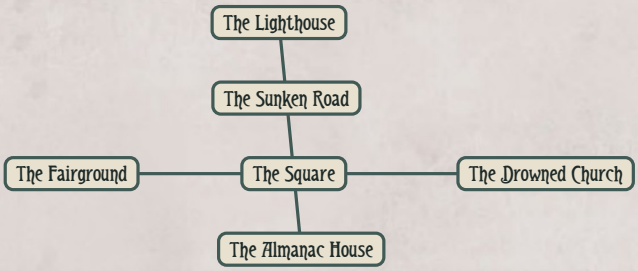
Use the scenario reference card's Easy / Standard side for Easy and Standard, and its Hard / Expert side for Hard and Expert.

4. **Take the Campaign Log** (the log token, or the pages at the back of this guide). The log token has three pages: page 1 holds the investigators, the loop counter and banked Memory; page 2 the Knowledge Track, Victory and threads; page 3 those who left the loop, your choices and the finale record. To turn the page, right-click the token and choose **Next page**. A choice is a row with two boxes, in the order the guide lists its options: tick the one you took. Seating fills page 1's investigators for you (**Fill investigators** on the token does it again). Record your difficulty. The log keeps what you have not yet learned hidden: each Knowledge entry, Named enemy and choice has a row, and its name appears on the token only when you tick it (on the printed pages, write it on the row's line). Each investigator starts at **0 Years**; banked Memory (one shared pool) starts at **0**.
5. Turn to **Prologue — The First Hour.**

Boxes. Every box has SCED's own **Place** and **Recall**. **Place** lays the box's cards out on the table at once and leaves the box empty. At the end of a loop click **Clear Board** on the Control token: it takes every district's cards off the table and fills each used box again, ready for its next **Place**. **Recall** puts one box's cards back into it (a district placed by mistake).

The Ambergrove Map

A small town at the end of a shore road, under a starless, snagged sky. **The Square** is the hub. The first move each round along a connection between two districts places 1 doom on the current Hour (see **Districts and travel**).



- **The Square** connects to the Fairground, the Drowned Church, the Almanac House and the Sunken Road.
- **The Sunken Road** connects the Square to the **Lighthouse**. The road runs on into the Lighthouse: moving between the Turning and the Winding Stair costs no time.
- Each district is a cluster of 2–4 locations. They enter play unrevealed unless their entry says otherwise. As the Rules Reference describes, when an investigator enters an unrevealed location, it is revealed: flip it, and SCED places its clues.

Prologue — The First Hour

You are in Ambergrove for your own reasons: a letter, a debt, a promise, a rumor. Soon, you will not remember them.

At dusk the last carts came in by the shore road, the sea on one side and dark fields on the other. At the end of that road the lighthouse stood unlit. Ask about it at the inn and you get a shrug. "No ship has needed it in years," the innkeeper says, and goes back to polishing a glass that is already clean.

Ambergrove is a town on no one's way to anywhere: a church, a road out to the shore, a dark lighthouse at the end of it, a printing house that sells almanacs to three counties. Tonight it is full. The almanac has promised an occultation, a star swallowed by the dark of something passing in front of it, once in a hundred years, and visible from here and nowhere else. People have come from every county the almanac reaches, with folding chairs and thermoses and copies of the almanac itself, the date and the hour of the occultation printed on its front page in fresh black type.

The whole town has turned out. Lanterns are strung across the Square. A band is tuning up by the Town Hall steps, where the sheriff is waiting to give his speech, and children ride their fathers' shoulders, pointing at a sky that is not quite right. Somewhere beyond the rooftops a bell is counting the hour. You lose the count.

The almanac promised the occultation at midnight. It is eleven, and the stars are already sliding behind something that has no edge. You will remember everything else.

If Elias Warde is one of your investigators, add:

Elias has kept that light for thirty-one years. Tonight, for the first time, he stands in the Square with everyone else, and he cannot say why he did not climb the stair.

Setup

On the Control token, click **Set Up Prologue** (on the Setup panel). It does all of this; check the table, choose a lead investigator and mulligan as normal.

1. **The First Hour** box is Placed. It lays out:
   - the **Hours** as the agenda deck, Hour I on top;
   - the act **The First Hour**;
   - **The Still Hour** scenario reference card;
   - the encounter deck, face down. Shuffle it;
   - the story card **The First Reset**, set aside. Read it when the Prologue ends.
2. **The Long Pier**, **The Square** and **The Almanac Steps** go into play in a row, in that order. The Square is revealed; the other two are unrevealed. Each investigator begins at **The Square** (their minicards are put there).
3. The Control token starts a new campaign in the Prologue, at **Hour I** with Dissonance **0**. The chaos bag is in the Calm band.
4. Each investigator takes 5 resources and draws an opening hand of 5 cards (a weakness drawn now is shuffled back and replaced). Choose a lead investigator and mulligan as normal. You are ready to begin.

The objective. The act **The First Hour** can advance only once the Hourglass has reached Hour VIII: investigators at The Almanac Steps spend the act's clues (2 per investigator) as a group. So the Prologue lasts about eight rounds or more. Each time an investigator enters The Almanac Steps, Dissonance rises by 1 (it is printed on the location); staying there costs nothing more, so enter it as few times as you can rather than going back and forth.

There is no Appointed in the Prologue, and no Years are gained in it: ignore any text that refers to the Appointed, and A Year in a Night gives no Year. The Prologue ends when The First Hour advances, or the way a loop does: at Hour IX, when every investigator is defeated, or when Dissonance reaches the reset value. Its locations belong to no district, so moving between them never places doom.

Note. The Prologue teaches the loop. It cannot be lost: however it ends, the night resets, and how well you did decides one small reward.

Do not read until the end of the scenario.

Resolution 1 – You Saw It Coming (you advanced The First Hour)

You were standing on the right step at the right second. You watched the occultation complete, and you watched something reach through, and not finish reaching. When the night folds, you fold with it on purpose, and you keep more of it.

- Each investigator gains **2 banked Memory**, and the party gains **1** more. (Click **Prologue reward** once, then **Memory** once.)

Resolution 2 – It Caught You Unready (the Hourglass reached Hour IX, or Dissonance reached the reset value)

The occultation completes. Something reaches through, and does not finish reaching. The night folds. You are standing in the Square again at eleven o'clock, salt on your tongue, and you are the only ones who feel the seam.

- Each investigator gains **2 banked Memory.** (Click **Prologue reward** once.)

No Resolution – The First Death (every investigator was defeated)

The last thing you see is the sky finishing what it started: the final star sliding behind the edgeless dark. There is no pain. There is a long, patient silence, like a held breath. Then a band is tuning up, and the lanterns are being lit, and it is eleven o'clock. You remember dying. You remember all of it.

- Each investigator gains **2 banked Memory.** (Click **Prologue reward** once.)
- This first death is free. None of the others will be.

Whichever ending you read: record **You Are Unstuck** in your Campaign Log (on the log token, also tick that ending in **Prologue ended**). Part I begins. Then read **What You Saw**.

What You Saw

Salt on your tongue. The same lanterns, the same band, the same children on the same shoulders. You look at one another across the Square and see it in each other's faces: you all remember. No one else does. It does not feel like the first time this night has happened, only the first time you noticed. A woman in a green shawl asks if you are feeling well.

At the edge of the lantern light you compare what you remember: the wrong sky, the hour, the fold. Whatever this night is, no one in Ambergrove will help you end it. Somewhere in this town is the reason the night will not finish. You will learn the night street by street, and you will end it, before it takes more years from you than you have.

The investigators must decide (choose one):

- **Tell the town.** Stand on the Town Hall steps and tell them what is coming, though they will not believe a word. Record in your Campaign Log: *The town was warned.*
- **Tell no one.** Whatever this is, it is yours to carry, and a secret kept is a card still in the hand. Record in your Campaign Log: *You kept the night to yourselves.*

Then, on the Control token, click **Reset Loop** (if it says the loop is not over by its count, click it again). This ends the Prologue; the Prologue does not count as a loop. Read **Between Loops**, then begin Loop 1 at **The Loop**.

The Loop

Play every loop from here on the same way: set it up, play the night across the districts you choose, and when it ends read the loop's resolution, then **Between Loops**. **Choose one path and follow it:** plan the loop around one line of objectives and see it through; an objective that needs another district's entry first belongs to a later loop.

Loop Setup

After **Begin Next Loop**, click **Set Up Loop** on the Control token. The Setup panel shows tonight's districts, picked for you from your Campaign Log: the districts with an objective left, the deeper objectives first, two at most (one path a loop), and the Sunken Road whenever the Lighthouse is picked. Click a district to change the pick, then click **Set Up Loop**. It does steps 1 to 3; check the table, then read step 4.

1. **Clear Board** (see **The reset**; never SCED's **Reset play areas**, which also removes your decks): every card the boxes laid out leaves the table and each used box is filled again. Each investigator is healed of all damage and horror, their clues, resources and Memory come off their cards, every card they own goes back into their deck and is shuffled (permanent cards and cards set aside beside their mat stay), and they take 5 resources and an opening hand of 5 (a weakness drawn now is shuffled back and replaced; mulligan as normal). Choose a lead investigator.
2. **The Square (Town Hall)** box is Placed, then each picked district's box, each once the one before is set up. Place does the rest of the setup and says so in the chat: each district's encounter set is shuffled into the encounter deck, set-aside cards go to one face-down pile on the mythos mat, The Appointed's Approach goes into play beside the Hours, from Part II the Appointed's Whispers join the encounter deck, and each act deck is set up from your Campaign Log (see **The Districts**). Everyone begins at **The Square** (the minicards are put there). You may Place a district later in the loop, just before an investigator moves into it (press **Place** on its box); no one can move into a district whose box is not placed.
3. The Control token counts the Memory an Elder or Ancient investigator starts with, and Anchor Point's (put a Memory token on their investigator card if you track Memory with tokens).
4. Read The Square's entry in **The Districts** (read each other district's entry the first time you enter it this loop). Apply the **standing rules** shown under your choices on page 3 of the log token (on the printed pages, write each under its choice), and any Knowledge entry that changes an Hour (the Hours deck itself never changes).

Salt on your tongue. Lanterns across the Square. A band tuning up. It is eleven o'clock, and you have been here before.

Do not read until the loop ends.

A loop ends the moment one of its endings happens. Before anything else, claim Victory for each Victory X location that qualifies (see **Victory**). Then check the endings **top to bottom** and read the first that happened. Then read the **district resolution** for each district whose box you placed this loop (see **The Districts**), and then **Between Loops**.

Resolution 2 – The Seam Tears (Dissonance reached the reset value)

You leaned on what you remembered until the night could feel the weight. Every clock in Ambergrove stops on the same wrong second. The sky does not fold this time. It splits, and you fall back through the gap to eleven o'clock, bleeding time.

- The loop ended in danger: each investigator's **+1 Year** for ending in the Noticed band or higher applies.
- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Torn**. If it is the first Torn loop, add 1 token to the chaos bag for the rest of the campaign (the Control token's difficulty buttons make this change for you).
- If this is the **second or later** Torn loop, read this instead of the usual interlude story: *The town has learned your shape. Strangers at the fair stop mid-laugh when you pass, and do not know why.*

No Resolution – The Night Keeps You (every investigator was defeated)

The dark finishes what it started. For a long moment there is nothing: no Square, no bell, no salt. Then the lanterns are being lit again, and you are standing where you always stand, and your hands will not stop shaking.

- Each investigator gains the **+1 Year** for being defeated.
- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Taken**.
- If this is the **second or later** Taken loop, read this instead of the usual interlude story: *You have died in this town more times than you can hold in your head at once. Each of you keeps one of those deaths close, like a stone in a pocket, and it is heavier every time.* If the Prologue ended in **The First Death**, add: *The first one was free. You remember being told so.*

Resolution 3 – You Walk Out of the Night (every investigator resigned or was defeated, and at least one resigned)

You leave the Square by the station road while the band is still playing. Behind you the night goes on without you, hour after hour, and at midnight it closes on an empty Square. Then the lanterns are being lit again, and you are standing where you always stand.

- Each defeated investigator gains the **+1 Year** for being defeated; an investigator who resigned does not.
- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Closed at the Hour**.

Resolution 1 – The Appointed Hour (the Hourglass reached Hour IX)

The occultation completes at the almanac's hour, an hour after it began. Something reaches through the edgeless dark, and, again, does not finish reaching. The night folds along its old crease. Eleven o'clock. Salt. The lanterns.

- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Closed at the Hour**.
- If you recorded **at least one** new Knowledge entry this loop, add to the interlude story: *Something of the night came loose in your hands. You hold on to that.* If you recorded **none**, add: *Another night spent. The town did not notice you at all, which is its own kind of warning.*

Between Loops

Run this after every reset, and once after the Prologue. First, if you have not already, click **Reset Loop** on the Control token; then click **Interlude** on it for steps 1 to 3.

1. **Age.** (Skip this step after the Prologue: it grants no Years, and Reset Loop discards its Years pending.) Each investigator adds their reset Years for the loop just ended plus their Years pending (see **Years**). Apply any bracket change now (the first time an investigator reaches Weathered, choose their skills on the Interlude panel before clicking **Age**), then tick the same skills in the investigator's panel on page 1 of the Campaign Log (Sync from campaign does this on the log token). An investigator who reaches 18 Years ages out; the first time anyone does, add 1 ☠2 to the chaos bag for the rest of the campaign (the Control token's difficulty buttons make this change for you).
2. **Bank Memory.** On the Interlude panel, click **Bank on-card Memory** once. It moves all Memory on cards (including the cards of investigators defeated this loop) to banked Memory. Memory on the cards of an investigator who aged out at step 1 is lost with them. Then take the Memory tokens off your cards.
3. **Spend.** Spend banked Memory as **Memory** describes (Recollections, upgrades and new level 0 cards; upgraded cards replace their base versions). For a new level 0 card, right-click the banked **Memory** button once. Once your log records The Way the Night Breaks, **Before the finale** says what to keep.
4. **Record.** The log token fills itself in from the Control token (loops, banked Memory, Years, skill changes, quest tallies and the Part on page 1; Knowledge and Victory on page 2), each page when it is shown. On page 3, tick any new choices and write anyone who aged out under **Those Who Left the Loop**; on page 1, write what you spent and on what. On the printed pages, write it all by hand. (Tick any Knowledge entry or Victory still missing before **Begin Next Loop**.)
5. **Check the Part.** If Part II has not begun, and your log now records **3 or more** surface Knowledge entries or you have completed **Loop 3**, Part II begins (see **Parts of the campaign**): add 1 ☠ to the chaos bag for the rest of the campaign (the Control token's difficulty buttons make this change for you), and read **The Shape of the Hour** at step 6.
6. **Read** one interlude story: the Torn or Taken story if the loop's resolution gave one, otherwise the loop-count story below, with any sentence the resolution adds (after the Prologue, What You Saw was its interlude story: read none here). Then read any age story, **The Shape of the Hour** if Part II began at step 5, and **Before the finale** if your log records The Way the Night Breaks and you have not read it yet. Click **Begin Next Loop** and turn to **Loop Setup**.

If your Campaign Log records The Road Remembers, add to the story you read: Some nights you dream the Sunken Road, walking it toward town the way the walkers never do, counting the milestones down. You always wake before the last one.

> **After each of the first three loops.** You wake at First Dark with the taste of salt and the certainty that you have done this before. The others feel it too. No one in Ambergrove will believe you.

After the fourth and fifth loops. The night is the same. You are not. You catch yourself counting the hours in your sleep, and waking at eleven before the bell. The town is exactly as young as it was the first time. Every morning that never comes, you are a little older than it.

After the sixth loop and every later loop. You no longer count the loops. You count what is left: the Years in your hands, the Memory in the pool, the few things the night has not yet told you. The town is as young as ever. You are running out of night to spend.

Age stories. The first time any investigator reaches a new age bracket, read its story aloud as well.

- **Weathered** (5 Years): *In a darkened shopfront there is a line beside your mouth that was not there when you came. The reflection notices it before you do.*
- **Elder** (10 Years): *The Town Hall steps seem higher than they used to. They are not. You count them each night, and each night it takes you longer to reach the top.*
- **Ancient** (15 Years): *A child in the Square takes your hand to help you down the Town Hall steps. You have known this child for every night you can remember. To them you are a kind old stranger, and always will be.*
- If an investigator **ages out** (18 Years): *They do not wake at First Dark. You find them on the Sunken Road, walking in the same direction as the others, hood up. They do not turn when you call their name.*
- If **no investigator can continue** (every investigator has aged out and no new investigator takes their place), the campaign ends here. Read: *Eleven o'clock comes, and no one is standing in the Square to feel it. The lanterns are lit, the band tunes up, and the night goes on without anyone left to remember it.* Do not read **The Last Hour** or the epilogue.

The Shape of the Hour (when Part II begins). The town has begun to notice that you notice. Somewhere past the edge of the Square, something that has been climbing politely toward the Square all night, every night, begins to whisper. From the next loop, each district's second objective opens, the Appointed's Whispers join the encounter deck, and the Named enter the night.

Before the finale (once your log records The Way the Night Breaks; if you begin the finale in the loop in which you first record it, read this first). You know the shape of the night now. You know what it costs to end it. Something has held this night in place all along, the way an anchor holds against the tide. The only question left is who pays. You may attempt **The Last Hour** during any loop from now on, or keep looping to prepare, knowing each loop costs years.

A fair warning, in the open: if the finale fails and you cannot offer the night enough, the campaign ends there. To keep a second attempt, enter the finale with at least **4 banked Memory per investigator** (12 at three) still in the pool. Banked Memory is the pool, not Memory on your cards: Memory still on cards when the finale begins does not count.

The Districts

Read a district's entry the first time you enter it in a loop (The Square's during Loop Setup). Its objectives are printed on its act deck: act 1a (a surface objective) can be completed in either part; act 2a (a deep objective) and act 3a (a late objective, which readies you for the finale) only in Part II. When an act tells you to record something in your Campaign Log, do so at once. It lasts through every reset.

A district's act deck. Each placed district has its own current act. The first act deck laid out in a loop takes the **Act** slot of the mythos mat; each further one sits in its own place in the row just below the mat. Place sets each act deck up from your Campaign Log and says in the chat which act is current:

- If your Campaign Log records its late (act 3a) record, remove its act deck from the game: its objectives are complete.
- Otherwise, if your log records its deep (act 2a) entry: remove acts 1a and 2a from the game; act 3a is the district's current act.
- Otherwise, if your log records its surface (act 1a) entry: in Part I, remove the act deck from the game. In Part II, remove act 1a from the game; then, if act 2a's requirements are met, act 2a becomes the district's current act (resolve its "When this act becomes the current act" ability now); if they are not, remove the act deck from the game.
- Otherwise, act 1a is the district's current act.

If act 1a would advance to an act 2a whose requirements are not met, remove the act deck from the game instead.

District resolutions. When a loop ends, after its loop resolution, read one resolution for **each district whose box you placed this loop** (always including The Square). Check each district's resolutions **top to bottom** and read the first that applies; if you completed its act 3a this loop, also read its **Resolution 4**. They tell what the night did with what you found there; anything they describe was already recorded on the act's back when you completed it, so they add nothing further to the log unless they say so. If you defeated a district's Named enemy this loop, read the Named add-on in that district's Resolution 1 whichever of its resolutions you read. Read that add-on only once; if the chosen resolution tells you to read it instead of its story, follow that instruction.

Choices. The first time you complete a district's deep objective, its resolution asks the investigators to decide between two courses. Record the choice in your Campaign Log (**Choices**). Every choice echoes somewhere else in Ambergrove, and every one of them is waiting for you in **The Last Hour**.

The Lighthouse

The lamp at the end of the Sunken Road is dark. It has never, in any loop, been lit, and no one in Ambergrove can say why it was left dark. The stair winds up into the smell of old oil and older salt.

If your Campaign Log already records The Lamp Remembers, read this instead:

The beam you lit is gone, as if it had never been. The wick is dry again, the glass is cold, and the stair has forgotten your footsteps. But your hands have not forgotten the way up.

If your Campaign Log records The walkers keep their ring, add the following. This loop, after The Lantern Room's lamp is lit (by Light the Lamp or by The Lantern Room's ➠), exhaust each Echo in the Sunken Road district.

Far below, on the Sunken Road, the walkers have stopped. Every hood is turned toward the tower, waiting, as though someone once promised them a light.

If your Campaign Log records You carry the walker's ring, add:

Halfway up the stair the ring turns cold on your finger. For a few steps you hear someone climbing behind you, keeping exact time with your feet. When you stop, they stop. When you look back, the stair is empty.

If your Campaign Log records that an investigator signed the ninth line, add:

The keeper's book lies open on the shelf, and the ninth line is filled in a new hand. The ink is still wet, though the night has folded since.

If your Campaign Log records The ninth line was left blank, add:

The keeper's book lies open on the shelf, the ninth line still empty. Someone has drawn a careful stroke through it, as if to say: no one.

If your Campaign Log records The Wheel Still Turns, add:

From the gallery the fair is small and bright, the wheel turning against the wrong sky. You have looked at this tower from the top of that wheel. Up here it is easy to believe that, all night, every night, the tower has been looking back.

When you Place this box: The Lighthouse is reached only through the Sunken Road, so Place the Sunken Road's box too. The Lantern Room (revealed), The Winding Stair and The Keeper's Quarters join the map. Encounter set: The Dark That Waits, Something on the Stair. Act deck: **Light the Lamp** (1a), then 2a and 3a in Part II. Its story asset is set aside.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – The Ninth Line (you completed The Keeper's Ninth Death this loop)

You carry the logbook down with you, though you know it will be back on its shelf at eleven o'clock. Eight deaths, each dated tonight, each in the same careful hand. The ninth line is ruled and waiting. The keeper of this light has been dying for it a long time, and has been writing it down so that someone, someday, would read it.

- If **Elias Warde** is one of your investigators, add: *Elias does not speak on the walk back. At the Square he stops, and says, to no one, "Eight. I thought it was more." Then he goes on.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
  - **Sign the ninth line.** One investigator writes their own name on the waiting line, so that whoever keeps this light next is someone who chose it. The book takes its due at once: that investigator gains **1 Year** (click **Years pending** on their card). Record in your Campaign Log: *<that investigator> signed the ninth line.*
  - **Leave it blank.** Nobody else will be written into this book. Record in your Campaign Log: *The ninth line was left blank.*

Resolution 2 – A Light on the Water (you completed Light the Lamp this loop)

For the rest of the night the beam swept the water, and the town below seemed to hold its breath beneath it. Then the night folded, and the light went out with everything else. It does not matter. You have done it once. The lamp will remember being lit, the way a door remembers being opened.

- If **Elias Warde** is one of your investigators, add: *Elias kept his hand on the lamp's brass until the last second. He still cannot remember why he left it dark. He is beginning to suspect that he was never given the chance.*

Resolution 3 – The Keeper's Round (you completed neither Light the Lamp nor The Keeper's Ninth Death this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The stair is the same: the same smell of oil, the same cold glass, the same dark water. There is a kind of comfort in it now. Whatever the Lighthouse still has to tell you, it will keep until you come back for it.

- If your Campaign Log records The Keeper's Ninth Death, read this instead: *The stair is the same: the same smell of oil, the same cold glass, the same dark water. The keeper's book has nothing left to tell you. You climb anyway, out of habit, and the tower lets you.*

Resolution 4 – Until Morning (you completed Keep the Light this loop; read in addition to the first resolution that applies)

You stayed with it. All night the beam went out across the water and came back, and nothing on the stair could put it out while someone sat beside the lamp. When the night folded, the light folded with it, but the tower remembers now what it is like to be kept. Somewhere past the loop, a morning is waiting for it.

No Resolution – The Dark Keeps Its Lamp (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

The light stayed dark. The tower stands against the wrong sky like a finger raised for silence. Somewhere at the top of it, you are sure, something is waiting to be lit.

The Drowned Church

> The bell tolled thirteen times at the occultation. It should toll twelve. Water stands in the nave to the height of the pews, and the congregation is still kneeling in it.

If your Campaign Log already records The Thirteenth Toll, read this instead:

> You count the strokes before they come. Twelve, and the pause, and the thirteenth. The congregation kneels in the black water exactly where it knelt before. None of them look up. The register in the Vestry has closed itself again.

If your Campaign Log records You have spoken the name, add:

> The kneeling congregation is murmuring now, all of them, the same two syllables over and over under the black water. You know the word. You were the one who said it first.

If your Campaign Log records The name is kept unspoken, add:

> When the bell strikes, you feel the name behind your teeth, and keep it there.

If your Campaign Log records The drowned heard the true hour, add:

> The kneeling congregation counts with the bell now: twelve, and then they stop, though the bell does not.

If your Campaign Log records The Sheriff Is Already Dead, add:

> At the end of the front pew one place is empty, a hat floating on the black water where a man would kneel. No one in the congregation looks at it.

When you Place this box: The Nave, The Belfry, The Vestry and The Flooded Crypt join the map. The Flooded Crypt enters play closed; the district's second act (2a) opens it, and it enters play open (revealed) in every loop once your Campaign Log records that act's deep entry. Encounter set: The Drowned Choir, The Drowned Verger, Thirteen, Rising Water. Act deck: **Why Thirteen?** (1a), then 2a and 3a in Part II. Its story assets are set aside. **Part II:** a new enemy joins this district, set aside until the second act spawns it.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – The Page Beneath the Water (you completed The Hour Was Wrong this loop)

You come up out of the crypt with the page held flat against your chest, water running out of your sleeves. One hour. The whole night hangs on one misprinted hour. When the loop folds, you feel it close differently, as though a crease at the edge of the night has been smoothed flat, and the road will hold.

- If you defeated **The Bell-Ringer Beneath** this loop, add: *Below the flooded steps the rope hangs slack. For the rest of that night, and only that night, the thirteenth stroke never came.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine stood in the nave with her palm against the cold stone until the water rose. "I heard it," she says afterward. "The first night, here, and for weeks before that, very far off. I heard it strike thirteen, and I reached for it."*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
  - **Carry the page to the Press.** Where the wrong hour was set, the right one can be set again. Record in your Campaign Log: *The true page reached the Press.* Standing rule, from the next loop on: group limit once per loop, when the round's first move between The Square and The Reading Room would place doom on the current Hour, it places none (it is still that round's first move).
  - **Read it to the drowned.** They have knelt in the water all night waiting for someone to tell them the hour. Record in your Campaign Log: *The drowned heard the true hour.* Standing rule, from the next loop on: the first time **Thirteen** is drawn each loop, cancel its revelation effect. The drowned keep the count for you.

Resolution 2 – Twelve Strokes and One (you completed Why Thirteen? this loop)

You close the register on the torn thirteenth stroke. Someone in this church knew the bell had rung wrong, and pressed so hard the nib went through. When the bell tolls the next hour, you listen to the thirteenth ring with new ears. It is not an echo. It is a count that does not end.

- If you defeated **The Bell-Ringer Beneath** this loop, end this resolution's story after "...pressed so hard the nib went through." Then read Resolution 1's first add-on in place of the rest.
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine does not look at the belfry for the rest of the night. When you ask why, she says only that she has heard that bell before, and not in this town.*

Resolution 3 – Kneeling Water (you completed neither Why Thirteen? nor The Hour Was Wrong this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The church kept its secrets tonight, and kept its congregation, kneeling and patient in the black water. You know more of it than they do. It is less comforting than it should be.

- If your Campaign Log records The Hour Was Wrong, read this instead: *The congregation knelt in the black water and the bell counted past twelve, as it always will. You have already carried up the one thing the church was keeping. Below the flooded steps there is nothing left but the cold.*
- If you defeated **The Bell-Ringer Beneath** this loop, read Resolution 1's first add-on instead of this resolution's story.

Resolution 4 – The Hour It Should Have Kept (you completed Toll the True Hour this loop; read in addition to the first resolution that applies)

For one stroke the bell told the truth. Down in the crypt the water went still, and every clock in Ambergrove, for the length of the note, agreed with it. Then the night went back to its own hour. But you heard the true one, and so did the thing on the hill: it was invited for that hour, and that hour has been rung.

No Resolution – The Count Goes On (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You leave with the bell still counting behind you. Twelve. Thirteen. You do not remember the moment you started counting along with it, under your breath, like a prayer you were taught as a child.

The Sunken Road

The road between the town and the shore. The same figures walk it every loop, in the same direction, hoods up, never arriving. None of them looks up as you pass.

If your Campaign Log already records The Road Remembers, read this instead:

The walkers are already on the road when you reach it, as they always are, going the way they always go. You know the milestones by heart now, counting up toward the shore and down toward the town. One of the hooded figures slows, just slightly, as you pass.

If your Campaign Log records that an investigator signed the ninth line, add:

One of the walkers carries a book under their arm, bound in oilcloth like the keeper's log. As you pass, they turn it so you can see the spine. There is fresh ink on it.

If your Campaign Log records The ninth line was left blank, add:

At the Turning a walker stops and lifts their hood toward the tower, the way someone looks for a name they expected to be called. Then they walk on.

If your Campaign Log records You carry the walker's ring, add:

The walkers part around you. One reaches for your hand, finds the ring, and lets go.

If your Campaign Log records You hold the ticket, add:

Where the road narrows, the walkers glance at your pocket, where the ticket is, and step aside as if for a paying passenger.

If your Campaign Log records You refused the ticket, add:

One of the walkers holds out a hand as you pass, palm up, like a conductor waiting for a fare. Then the hand drops.

If your Campaign Log records The Lamp Remembers, add:

Once, as you pass, every walker on the road stops mid-stride and turns toward the dark tower, as if somewhere up there a match had been struck. Then, together, they walk on.

When you Place this box: The Milestones, The Low Bridge and The Turning join the map. Encounter set: The Waiting Congregation, The Mile-Counter, The Bridge Remembers. Act deck: **Walk It Backward** (1a), then 2a and 3a in Part II.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – Worn Smooth (you completed Who Walks Beside You this loop)

You cannot stop seeing the face beneath the hood, worn smooth as a step, and the ring on the hand that rose to stop you. When the night folds you look for them in the crowd at the Square, and do not find them. They are on the road. They are always on the road. You wonder, for the first time, how many loops it takes to wear a face away, and what a night like this needs to hold it in place.

- If **"Birdie" Okonkwo** is one of your investigators, add: *Birdie's compass swung toward the walker and held there, steady as north, until the night ended. She has not put it away since.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
  - **Take the ring.** The walker holds out their hand and lets you draw the ring from their finger, as if it had been waiting a long time to be carried somewhere else. Record in your Campaign Log: *You carry the walker's ring.*
  - **Leave it with them.** It is the last thing they have that is theirs. Record in your Campaign Log: *The walkers keep their ring.*

Resolution 2 – Against the Walkers (you completed Walk It Backward this loop)

You walked the road backward, and the road let you. The walkers did not stop you; some of them, you are almost sure, stepped aside. Whatever this road is, it has learned your shape, and you have learned its. Once a night, you will not lose an hour on it.

- If **"Birdie" Okonkwo** is one of your investigators, add: *"I came in on this road," Birdie says. "The wrong night. I remember the milestones counting down." No one asks her what they were counting down to.*

Resolution 3 – Same Direction (you completed neither Walk It Backward nor Who Walks Beside You this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The walkers went the way they always go, and so did the night. Along the milestones, none of them arrived. None of them ever will, unless someone changes the road.

- If your Campaign Log records Who Walks Beside You, read this instead: *The walkers went the way they always go, and so did the night. You know one face among them now. It does not make the road any shorter.*

Resolution 4 – Miles to Morning (you completed The Last Milestone this loop; read in addition to the first resolution that applies)

The new stone stands at the edge of the fog with its impossible number cut into it. You do not know if anyone will ever walk that far. But the road has an end now, written down, and a road with an end is a road somebody can finish. The walkers have stopped circling. They are waiting to see who goes first.

No Resolution – Hoods Up (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You never learned where the walkers are going. At the end of the night they were still walking, and so, you realize as the night folds, were you: the same direction, hood of darkness up, not quite arriving.

The Square

> The hub of the night. The sheriff stands on the Town Hall steps giving the same speech to the same crowd. He has been dead since ten o'clock. No one has noticed but you.

If your Campaign Log already records The Sheriff Is Already Dead, read this instead:

> The sheriff clears his throat on the Town Hall steps and begins the speech you know by heart. You mouth the words along with him. You know exactly where he is: at the bottom of the Well.

If your Campaign Log records The town was warned, add:

> Near the back of the crowd a woman in a green shawl is not watching the sheriff. She is watching you, frowning, the way you frown at a word on the tip of your tongue.

If your Campaign Log records The Lamp Remembers, add:

> Out past the rooftops the lighthouse is dark again. Now and then someone in the crowd glances toward it, as if they half expect it to come on, and cannot say why.

If your Campaign Log records The vote was torn out, add:

> The applause at the end of the speech is ragged, as if some of the crowd no longer remember what they are agreeing to.

If your Campaign Log records The vote still stands, add:

> The applause comes exactly on cue, every hand at once.

Every loop: the Square's box is placed in Loop Setup. It lays out the Hours as the agenda deck and the loop's encounter deck (the five shared sets plus its own, The Crossing, The Band on the Steps, The Same Speech, The Crowd Turns); The Square and The Town Hall Steps enter play revealed, The Well and The Records Office unrevealed. The Appointed's Approach goes into play beside the Hours, and The Appointed starts the set-aside pile; from Part II the Appointed's Whispers join the encounter deck. Act deck: **The Sheriff Is Already Dead** (1a), then 2a and 3a in Part II, set up from your Campaign Log like any district's. Its story asset is in the set-aside pile. **Part II:** a new enemy joins this district, set aside until the second act spawns it.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – Carried, Unanimous (you completed The Vote That Never Ends this loop)

Every name in Ambergrove, each in its own hand. You have walked past these people a hundred times: the baker, the band, the children on their fathers' shoulders. They signed. They wanted the door open, and they agreed to a price, and then they forgot. The applause for the sheriff's speech sounds different to you now. It sounds like a vote being taken again.

- If you defeated **What Wears the Sheriff** this loop, add: *It did not fall like a man. It folded, and for a moment the Town Hall steps were empty. Then the speech began again, from a mouth that was only a sheriff's.*
- If **Elias Warde** is one of your investigators, add: *Elias finds his own name, in his own hand. He does not remember signing.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine ran a finger down every name in the ledger. Hers is not there. She is not relieved.*
- If your Campaign Log records *The town was warned*, add: *One name near the bottom has been struck through, fresh, the ink still wet. Somebody listened to you, once, and took their name back. Caught in the fold of the page is a thread of green wool.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
  - **Tear out the page.** No debt the town cannot remember agreeing to should be collected. Record in your Campaign Log: *The vote was torn out.*
  - **Leave the vote standing.** A promise, however foolish, is how this began. It may be how it ends. Record in your Campaign Log: *The vote still stands.*

Resolution 2 – The Body in the Well (you completed The Sheriff Is Already Dead this loop)

You looked down the Well and saw him, and then looked up at the steps and saw him again, giving his speech to the lanterns. The town is not just repeating. Something is wearing it, the way a hand wears a glove. You spend the rest of the night studying faces and trying not to wonder which of them are still their own.

Resolution 3 – The Same Speech (you completed neither The Sheriff Is Already Dead nor The Vote That Never Ends this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The speech ended the way it always ends, and the crowd answered it. You stood at the back and knew what they did not, and the knowing sat in you like a stone.

- If your Campaign Log records The Vote That Never Ends, read this instead: *The speech ended the way it always ends, and the crowd answered it. You know the minutes now. You stood at the back and kept your hands still.*
- If you defeated **What Wears the Sheriff** this loop, read Resolution 1's first add-on instead of this resolution's story.

Resolution 4 – The Roll (you completed Call the Roll this loop; read in addition to the first resolution that applies)

You read every name. Some of the crowd wept; some only listened, as if hearing a song they had forgotten writing. When you finished, nobody gave the speech. For one night the town stood in its own Square and knew what it had agreed to, and who had agreed. The Past remembers being read aloud.

No Resolution – Eleven O'Clock (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

The lanterns, the band, the sheriff on the steps. You passed through the Square as everyone passes through it tonight, and it let you go. At the end of the night you are back in it, as you always will be, until you learn what it is hiding.

The Fairground

The occultation fair, mid-celebration, forever. The wheel turns. The music never finishes its tune. The ticket-taker smiles at you the way he smiles at everyone, and counts you under his breath.

If your Campaign Log already records The Wheel Still Turns, read this instead:

The music starts the same bar it started last time and gets no further. The wheel is turning. You know how the town looks from the top of it now, and you know how still it is. The ticket-taker lifts his hat to you, as he always does, as if you were old friends.

If your Campaign Log records You kept the night to yourselves, add:

The ticket-taker catches your eye across the crowd and touches one finger to the side of his nose. A man who keeps a secret knows another who does.

If your Campaign Log records The vote was torn out, add:

Here and there in the crowd someone stops cheering mid-breath and looks around, as if they have forgotten what they came to celebrate.

If your Campaign Log records The vote still stands, add:

The crowd at the fair cheers on the same beat as the crowd in the Square, though neither can hear the other.

If your Campaign Log records You hold the ticket, add:

The ticket in your pocket is warm. When the ticket-taker's count comes round to you, he skips you, as if you had already paid.

If your Campaign Log records You refused the ticket, add:

The ticket-taker counts you as you pass, and frowns at the total, as if it never quite comes out right.

When you Place this box: The Wheel, The Hall of Mirrors and The Ticket Booth join the map. Encounter set: ⛤ The Barker, The Wheel's Turn, Your Reflection Lies. Act deck: **The Wheel Still Turns** (1a), then 2a and 3a in Part II. **Part II:** a new enemy joins this district's encounter set; it spawns at **The Wheel** when drawn.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – The Fare (you completed The Ticket-Taker's Bargain this loop)

He named no price for the way out. He only told you there was one, and that you would know it when you could afford it. As the night folds you can still hear the fair music playing its one unfinished bar, and under it, very softly, the punch of a ticket.

- If you defeated **The One Who Rides Forever** this loop, add: *The wheel stopped, and for the rest of that night it stayed stopped. It started again at eleven o'clock, as though nothing had happened. Something had.*
- If **Cass Lindqvist** is one of your investigators, add: *He called Cass by name and asked after her debts. Cass has never told anyone in Ambergrove about her debts. She spends the rest of the night working out the odds on how he knew, and does not like any of them.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
  - **Take the ticket.** He holds it out between two fingers. It is warm, and blank, and it is yours. Record in your Campaign Log: *You hold the ticket.*
  - **Refuse it.** Whatever he is selling, you will find another way out. Record in your Campaign Log: *You refused the ticket.* Standing rule, from the next loop on: the first time a **Lost Hour** is drawn each loop, cancel its revelation effect. The fair's clock stops for you, once: you owe the fair no fare, and the night cannot charge you the hour.

Resolution 2 – The Whole Town at Once (you completed The Wheel Still Turns this loop)

From the top of the wheel you saw Ambergrove laid out like a hand of cards face up on the table: every street still, no one moving, the church, the road, the dark tower at the end of it. Some part of you has kept that view. You find you can call it up with your eyes closed.

- If **Cass Lindqvist** is one of your investigators, add: *Cass counted the town from up there the way she counts a deck. "Somebody's dealing," she says afterward. "I just can't see the hand."*

Resolution 3 – One More Ride (you completed neither The Wheel Still Turns nor The Ticket-Taker's Bargain this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The fair went on without you, as it always does, and the tune got no further than it ever gets. The ticket-taker went on waiting. He did not seem disappointed. He seems to have all the time in the world.

- If your Campaign Log records The Ticket-Taker's Bargain, read this instead: *The fair went on without you, and the tune got no further than it ever gets. The ticket-taker lifted his hat as you passed, the way a man greets a customer whose fare is already settled.*
- If you defeated **The One Who Rides Forever** this loop, read Resolution 1's first add-on instead of this resolution's story.

Resolution 4 – Standing Still (you completed Stop the Wheel this loop; read in addition to the first resolution that applies)

The wheel held until the night folded, its top car hanging against the wrong sky. For all that time nothing at the fair turned, and nothing at the fair could pretend the night was going anywhere. Whatever is coming for the town has to come the long way now, through a morning that has not happened yet.

No Resolution – The Tune That Doesn't End (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

Lights, music, the wheel going round. You walked through the fair and it walked through you, and when the night folded you could still hear the tune, stopping, as it always stops, one note short of the end.

The Almanac House

> Where the almanac was printed. Stacks of it still wait by the press, bound and dated, the hour of the occultation set in fresh black type. At the back, a study door that no key in Ambergrove fits.

If your Campaign Log already records What the Almanac Hid, read this instead:

> The press has set the wrong hour again since the night folded, as if you had never touched it. The stacks are bound and waiting. But the study door at the back is not as closed as it was. You can feel it, the way you feel someone behind you in an empty room.

If your Campaign Log records The Appointed's Name, read this instead:

> The press has set the wrong hour again, as it always will. At the back of the house the study door stands open, and inside it is eleven o'clock exactly. You have read everything this house was keeping. What is left is to decide when to use it.

If your Campaign Log records The true page reached the Press, add:

> The page you brought up out of the flooded crypt lies on the bed of the press, dry now, and beside the wrong type in the bed someone has set the true hour, letter by letter, ready to go in. Someone has been working here in the loops you were not watching. They have propped the side door to the Square open with a wedge of type.

If your Campaign Log records The drowned heard the true hour, add:

> Under the floorboards, faint as water moving in a pipe, a murmur of voices is counting, and they are not counting the hour on the page.

When you Place this box: The Reading Room, The Press and The Sealed Study join the map. The Sealed Study enters play closed; the district's second act (2a) opens it, and it enters play open (revealed) in every loop once your Campaign Log records that act's deep entry. Encounter set: 📖 The Compositor, The Page That Wasn't, Ink Runs Backward, The Study Door. Act deck: **What the Almanac Hid** (1a), then 2a and 3a in Part II (2a once your Campaign Log also records the Square's deep entry); until it does, Place removes this act deck once act 1a is complete. Its story asset is set aside.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – Written Once (you completed The Appointed's Name this loop)

You did not say it aloud. None of you did. But you carried it out of the study all the same, and the night felt you carry it. For a while afterward the thing on the hill came on more slowly, like a guest who has heard their name called from inside the house and is no longer sure of their welcome.

- If **Dr. Ayako Sōma** is one of your investigators, add: *Ayako knows the language it is written in. She has spent her life trying to find someone who spoke it. She has found them.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine knows the name. She heard it once before, on the night she reached for the sky and something, very politely, reached back.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
  - **Speak the name.** Once, aloud, into the empty study, so that it knows you know. The night takes its price for that at once: each investigator gains **1 Year** (click **Years pending** on each investigator card). Record in your Campaign Log: *You have spoken the name.*
  - **Keep it unspoken.** A name held back is a name you can still use. Record in your Campaign Log: *The name is kept unspoken.*

Resolution 2 – The Altered Hour (you completed What the Almanac Hid this loop)

For the rest of the night the reprinted pages lay warm on the press, with the struck hour left blank, and the sky above the Almanac House was almost ordinary. Almost. When the night folds, the press will set the changed hour again. But you know now that somebody changed it by hand, after the proofs were pulled. The changed proof cannot tell you what was there before.

- If your Campaign Log does not record The Vote That Never Ends, add: *The study door at the back still will not give. Somewhere in town, someone wrote down what is kept behind it.*
- If **Dr. Ayako Sōma** is one of your investigators, add: *In the margin of the reprint, in a hand she recognizes as her own, is a translation note Ayako does not remember writing. It is one word. The word is "wait."*

Resolution 3 – Fresh Black Type (you completed neither What the Almanac Hid nor The Appointed's Name this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The stacks were bound and dated. The press was set. There was still more to read, and at the back of the house the study kept whatever secrets it still had.

- If your Campaign Log records The Appointed's Name, read this instead: *The stacks were bound and dated. The press was set. The study at the back stands open, and there is nothing left in it that you did not carry out.*

Resolution 4 – Corrected Proof (you completed Set the Hour Right this loop; read in addition to the first resolution that applies)

One clean sheet, the ink still wet, the true hour printed where the brown ink lied. By morning the night had unmade it, as it unmakes everything. But a thing that has been printed correctly once can be proved, and the hour the town was promised to has been set right, if only on paper. Paper is where the promise was made.

No Resolution – Bound and Dated (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You leave the Almanac House with ink on your fingers and nothing in your hands. The stacks go on waiting by the press, bound and dated for tonight, the hour of the occultation set in fresh black type. Someone printed that hour. Someone wanted it believed.

Finale – The Last Hour

Only once your Campaign Log records The Way the Night Breaks. During any loop from then on, an investigator at **The Sealed Study** may begin the finale as a ↯ ability during their turn. Or, when Hour IX is reached while your log records The Way the Night Breaks, you may begin the finale instead of ending the loop.

The night will not wait. Once your log records all six late records, the next loop is the finale: begin it right after Loop Setup, wherever you are (Setup step 2, *Before Hour V*).

When to begin. Beginning the finale at Hour IX gives you the most time: the Hourglass goes back to Hour V (Setup, step 2). Beginning at Hours V to VIII leaves the Hourglass where it is, with fewer Hours before Hour IX ends the finale.

The finale and the loop. The finale is part of the loop in which it begins: damage, horror, cards in play, the Hourglass, Dissonance and every "once per loop" limit already used stay as they are. During the finale you may still Place a district's box before moving into it, as Loop Setup step 2 allows; set its act deck aside at once without resolving any of its abilities (the Control token does this). When the finale ends, first claim Victory, then read the finale resolution, then fill in the **Finale Record** on your Campaign Log (the loop, whether As It Is was defeated, banked Memory when the finale ended, the deep entries spent, the resolution, how the night ended and the Years paid). Memory still on cards does not count as banked Memory for Resolutions 1b, 5 and 6. After Resolution 5 the loop ends as usual: read each placed district's resolution (except one you read before the finale), then **Between Loops**. Investigators defeated during the finale are still present for the finale resolution and the epilogue: they wake at dawn with the others. After Resolutions 1–4 (including 1b), 7 and 8 the campaign ends and no reset Years are gained; for their conditions and the epilogue, an investigator's Years are their recorded Years plus their Years pending plus any Years the resolution gives.

Before the finale begins: if you have not yet read **Before the finale** (Between Loops), read it now. Then, if you completed a district's act this loop, read that district's resolution now (the first that applies) and make any choice it asks (any Years it gives are gained now: click **Years pending**). Then read:

> You have lived this night more times than you can hold. You know the ledger, the wrong sky, the name. And you know the brown ink: someone who signed that vote wrote the hour one late, to put the bill off by a single hour, and the whole town has been standing in that hour ever since. You know what the town agreed to: an appointment made in ink and never kept.
>
> You feel the loops in your body now. In the joints of your hands, in the way the Town Hall steps seem steeper each night. The town has not aged a single night. You have aged all of them.
>
> Out on the hill, the guest has stopped being polite. Tonight you will not be early. You will meet it in the hour it was invited, in the hour it means to keep, and in the hour where it stands, and you will decide what you are willing to spend.

Setup

On the Control token, click **Begin Finale**. It does steps 1 to 3 below for you and says so in the chat; check the table, then take **The Uninvited** and the forms' rules from **The fight**.

1. **The Last Hour** box is Placed (if it is not on the table yet). **Through the Hours** becomes the current act, in the **Act** slot of the mythos mat, and two periods join the map: **The First Occultation** (the Past, beside The Square) and **The Morning After** (the Future, beside The Town Hall Steps). Every district's act deck is set aside, and any enemy a district's act 2a spawned is removed from the game: no district objective can be completed during the finale. The box also lays out a face-down set-aside pile in the mythos area's lower corner. **The Uninvited** and the three forms of the Appointed (**As It Was**, **As It Will Be**, **As It Is**) come out of it; leave the rest face down: they are this finale's story and resolution cards, with the same text as this guide.
2. The Hourglass is set by the Hour the finale began at (the Hours on the table follow). Dissonance keeps its current value.
   - *At Hour IX:* Hours IX, VIII, VII and VI go back on the Hours deck in that order (Hour VI on top) and Hour V is the current agenda. No Hour resolves. Hours VII and VIII resolve again when they are reached (Hour VIII raises Dissonance by 2 again); Hour VI does not stack.
   - *At Hours V to VIII:* leave the Hourglass as it is. No Hour resolves again, and the Control token keeps its Hour.
   - *Before Hour V:* the Hourglass advances to Hour V (a Skip: each Hour resolves; resolve what the chat asks of each).
3. The Appointed is set aside (its Approach goes back to Unseen), and nothing moves its Approach for the rest of the finale: its forms take its place. **As It Was** spawns at The First Occultation, **As It Will Be** at The Morning After, **As It Is** at The Square, and **The Uninvited** at the revealed location farthest from all investigators. Then each of these your Campaign Log records applies:
   - *You have spoken the name:* 1 damage on As It Was. It already knows that you know.
   - *The drowned heard the true hour:* the Hourglass rewinds by 1 Hour. Below the church, a congregation is keeping time for you.
   - *The true page reached the Press:* until the finale ends, the chaos bag holds 1 fewer Static token than it otherwise would (never fewer than 0); this adds to Hour VI's "1 fewer" (What the Almanac Hid). Every almanac in town now carries the true hour, and the sky is a little less wrong. It is applied for you.
   - *You refused the ticket:* the fair's clock stops for you once more. Cancel the revelation effect of the first Lost Hour drawn during the finale, even if one was canceled earlier this loop (the chat reminds you).
   - *Each late record* (**Before the Last Hour** on your log): 1 damage to the form of its period, never more than half its health in all. **As It Was:** Every Name Was Read, The Bell Rang True, The Hour Is Set Right. **As It Will Be:** The Light Is Kept, The Road Has an End, The Wheel Stands Still.

The fight. The Appointed has a form in each period, each an Elite enemy whose health is per investigator. **As It Is** cannot be damaged until As It Was and As It Will Be have both been defeated, and it never leaves the Present. The first move each round into or out of The First Occultation, and the first into or out of The

Morning After, places 1 doom on the current Hour (their cards say so), so every trip through the hours costs time; the rest of the party can follow that round for free.

- **What you carry.** Each deep Knowledge entry your log records can be spent once, as an ➤➤ on Through the Hours while you are in its period, to deal 2 damage to the form there. It stays recorded for every other purpose, including the resolutions; note it on the Finale Record. Read its line aloud when you spend it:
  - *The Past.* The Vote That Never Ends: "You read it the minutes. It knows them better than you, but it listens." (If the vote was torn out: "You recite the minutes from memory. The torn page is not there to argue.") The Hour Was Wrong: "You tell it the true hour. It has been keeping the wrong one." The Appointed's Name: "You do not say it. You let it see that you could."
  - *The Future.* Who Walks Beside You: "On the road behind you the walkers stop, and turn, and wait with you." The Keeper's Ninth Death: "Eight times the keeper walked out along the beam and died. You tell it the ninth line is not its to write." The Ticket-Taker's Bargain: "Far off, a ticket is punched. Here, something checks its fare."
- **The Uninvited** hunts you through the night. Defeating it deals 2 damage to a form of the Appointed that can be damaged.
- **Hold Back** works only on As It Is: it disengages and exhausts it, and never rewinds the Hourglass in the finale.

Stop or press on. When As It Was or As It Will Be is defeated, the night loosens: rewind the Hourglass by 1 Hour (right-click **Hour** once; with one investigator, 2 Hours). Then decide at once. You may end the finale there, stranded in that period (Resolution 7 for the Past, 8 for the Future). If you press on and the finale ends before As It Is is defeated, the night takes you back: read Resolution 5 or 6. The finale ends when As It Is is defeated, when you stop, or when Hour IX is reached, every investigator has been defeated, or Dissonance reaches the reset value.

During the finale, if your log records:

- *You carry the walker's ring:* once during the finale, when an investigator Holds Back As It Is, they may do so without a skill test. Read aloud: *The ring turns cold on your finger. For one step someone stands beside you, keeping exact time with you, and the thing in front of you stops.*
- *The name is kept unspoken:* once during the finale, after setup, when the Hourglass would advance for any reason, the investigators may speak the name to cancel that entire advance (remove all doom from the current Hour). Read aloud: *You say it once, aloud, at last. Every clock in Ambergrove holds its breath, and the hand does not move.*

The first form falls. The first time a form of the Appointed is defeated, read aloud: *Every clock in Ambergrove stops, then starts again, ticking backward. For one breath you are all the ages you have ever been at once: young and tired and old, standing on every step of every stair you ever climbed in this town. Then the moment passes, and the hours close around you again, and somewhere in them the rest of it is waiting.*

Do not read until the end of the finale.

An investigator is **present** if they took part in the finale, even if they were defeated during it. After Resolutions 1–4 no investigator ages out (there is no Between Loops), except as Resolution 4 says.

When the finale ends, find where you stand:

- **If As It Is was defeated**, you are home, in the Present, and the night can be ended. **The investigators must decide how.** Choose **one** of Resolutions 1, 1b, 2, 3 or 4 whose condition you meet and read it. Resolution 4 is always available.
- **If you stopped after defeating As It Was or As It Will Be**, read Resolution 7 (the Past) or Resolution 8 (the Future).
- **Otherwise**, read Resolution 5 if banked Memory is at least 4 per investigator (12 at three investigators); otherwise read Resolution 6.

After Resolutions 1–4 (including 1b), read **Epilogue — What the Years Took.** Resolutions 7 and 8 have their own epilogue.

Resolution 1 – Take Its Place (As It Is defeated, and an Ancient investigator, or the investigator who signed the ninth line, is present)

Someone has to hold the night's crease closed from the inside. The one the night has marked knows it before anyone speaks. They take the lamp, or the pen, or simply each of your hands in turn, and they walk out onto the hill to stand where the guest stood.

- The investigators choose one present investigator who is Ancient or who signed the ninth line. That investigator becomes the night's new anchor: kept behind, decades older, so that the loop ends for everyone else. They do not come back down. Mark them **kept as anchor** under **Those Who Left the Loop**. Far down the Sunken Road, the walker with the worn ring stops at last and sits down at the roadside to rest.
- If your log records **Who Walks Beside You**, instead: the ones who walk the Sunken Road come up the hill and take the anchor's weight with you. At dawn the anchor walks out with the others, free and not kept, but **3 Years** older. If your log also records *The walkers keep their ring*, the walkers carry the anchor almost the whole way: **1 Year** older instead of 3.
- If the anchor signed the ninth line, add: *The keeper's book has its ninth line now, in a hand that chose it.*
- The town wakes for the first time in a hundred years. The campaign is over.

Resolution 1b – Let It In, On Your Terms (As It Is defeated, your log records The Ticket-Taker's Bargain and You hold the ticket, and banked Memory is at least 4 per investigator, or 3 per investigator if you kept the night to yourselves)

He punches your ticket without looking. He has been expecting you for a very long time. The door opens, not the way the town opened it, begging, but the way you open a door to a guest you have decided to receive. What is left of it comes in. It sits down at the edge of the Square in the lantern light, and it is smaller than you feared, and it is very, very old.

- If your log records *You kept the night to yourselves*, add: *As the door swings open he touches one finger to the side of his nose. A man who keeps a secret knows what one is worth.*
- The door opens on your terms, not the town's, and the night finally ends.
- The fare is everything you carried: banked Memory drops to **0**, and each present investigator gains **2 Years**.
- Ambergrove wakes to a morning with one more guest in it. The campaign is over.

Resolution 2 – Close the Door (As It Is defeated, and your log records The vote still stands)

You pay the price the town agreed to and never paid. It is paid in years, as every price here is. You feel them go, all at once, like stepping off a stair that is not there. When you look up the sky has an edge again, and the edge is the dawn.

- Each present investigator gains **3 Years** at once, and the door closes. If your log records *The town was warned*, Ambergrove remembers just enough to share the cost: **2 Years** each instead.
- The debt is paid, and the door stays shut. The campaign is over.

Resolution 3 – Break Through (As It Is defeated, and your log records The Keeper's Ninth Death)

You go the way the keeper tried eight times, along the beam and out over the water, and this time no one falls. You force the night open, and every present investigator runs through before it can close. Behind you the Square, the band, the lanterns, the sheriff on his steps, all fold away like a stage set in the rain.

- Every present investigator escapes, and each gains **2 Years**: the night closes on your heels. The campaign is over.
- But the loop is only paused. Somewhere, some night, an almanac will be printed with the wrong hour again. Was it really ended?
- If your log records *The ninth line was left blank*, read this instead of the last point: *No one is written into the keeper's book. No one is owed. The loop has nothing left to hold, and it does not start again.*
- If an investigator signed the ninth line, add: *Somewhere in the keeper's book a name is waiting. One night, the book may call it.*

Resolution 4 – Seal by Force (As It Is defeated)

The door is sealed, but not closed. Someone has to lean against it until the dawn comes, and the dawn is a long way off.

- The investigators choose one present investigator. They age out holding the door shut: write them under **Those Who Left the Loop** as aged out. The campaign is over.
- If your log records *The vote was torn out*, no debt is owed behind that door, and it pushes back with nothing but its own weight. The chosen investigator holds it until morning and walks away **3 Years** older instead of aging out.

Resolution 5 – Next Time (no form defeated, or you pressed on and As It Is stands; banked Memory at least 4 per investigator)

The loop wins tonight. The guest keeps its appointment, and the night folds along its old crease. But you have carried so much of it now that the fold does not quite close over you. You wake at First Dark closer than ever, older than ever, and certain.

- The loop ends. Mark it as its ending would: **Torn** if Dissonance reached the reset value (with that ending's chaos-bag change and interlude story), **Taken** if every investigator was defeated (with that ending's interlude story), otherwise **Closed at the Hour**. Read each placed district's resolution (a district whose resolution you read before the finale reads nothing more), and proceed to **Between Loops**. You may attempt the finale again. At the next attempt, fill in the Finale Record again.
- Do not read the epilogue yet.

Resolution 6 – The Loop Wins (no form defeated, or you pressed on and As It Is stands; banked Memory below 4 per investigator)

The night takes you. The town keeps repeating, and somewhere on the Sunken Road, walking the same direction and never arriving, there are new faces beneath the hoods.

- The campaign ends. Do not read the epilogue.

Resolution 7 – Stranded Before (you stopped after defeating As It Was)

You strike it down in the hour it was invited, and that hour closes around you like a door. When the lanterns are lit again they are new, and the band has not learned the tune. The clerk on the Town Hall steps is counting hands. You are in Ambergrove decades before you were born, and the night goes on, and in the morning there is a morning.

- The campaign is over. Read the epilogue below instead of **Epilogue — What the Years Took**.
- *You live out your lives in the old town. You know what it will vote for, and when, and what it will cost. Some of you try to stop it. Some of you only watch the young faces in the Square and remember them old. None of you ever buys an almanac.*
- If your Campaign Log records *The town was warned*, add: *One night, years on, a girl in a green shawl stops you in the street and asks if she knows you. You tell her not yet.*

Resolution 8 – Stranded After (you stopped after defeating As It Will Be)

You strike it down in the hour it meant to keep, and that hour holds you. When you look up, the Square is gray with morning. The bunting has rotted on its strings. The shore road is empty: whoever walked it has finished walking. The night is over, and it has been over for a long time.

- The campaign is over. Read the epilogue below instead of **Epilogue — What the Years Took**.
- *You come out into a world that went on without you. The almanac is out of print. No one in the new houses has heard of the occultation. Each of you finds a way to live in the years you were given, and on clear nights you look up, and the stars stay where they are.*
- If your Campaign Log records *Who Walks Beside You*, add: *At the end of the shore road someone has built a bench. On it, worn smooth, is a ring.*

Epilogue — What the Years Took. First, the dawn. Read once: *At midnight the church bell strikes twelve, and stops.* Then add each of these your Campaign Log records:

- *The Sheriff Is Already Dead: Someone finally lifts the board from the Well. The town buries its sheriff on an ordinary morning.*
- *The Wheel Still Turns: At the fairground the tune reaches its last bar, and the wheel stops with an empty car at the top.*

- *The Road Remembers:* The milestones on the shore road count in order, all the way to town.
- *The Lamp Remembers*, and no one was kept as anchor: *Out at the point the lamp stands dark, and for once it is only a lamp.*

Then read one line for each investigator who is present at the end, was not kept as anchor and did not age out, matching their age bracket after the resolution's Years.

- **Prime:** *You leave Ambergrove as young as you came, and no one on the train believes how tired you are.*
- **Weathered:** *There is gray in your hair that was not there the night you arrived. You keep it. It is the only proof.*
- **Elder:** *Your hands shake a little now in the mornings. You spent years on one night, and you would spend them again.*
- **Ancient:** *The station master helps you down from the carriage and asks if you have family meeting you. You had family, once. Tonight it feels like a hundred years ago.*
- An investigator **kept as anchor** has no epilogue. On clear nights in Ambergrove, the lamp at the end of the Sunken Road is lit.
- An investigator who **aged out holding the door** (Resolution 4) has no epilogue. Some nights, the people who live on the Square hear someone leaning against a door, waiting for the morning.
- If more of your loops are marked **Closed at the Hour** than **Torn** and **Taken** together, also read once: *You kept the night's hours more often than you broke them. Years from now, someone in Ambergrove will half remember a few patient strangers at the occultation, and not know why it matters.*
- If your Campaign Log records *The town was warned* and any investigator leaves Ambergrove, also read once, for the whole party: *On the platform a woman in a green shawl watches you board. She raises a hand, uncertain, the way you wave to someone you almost remember.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** has an epilogue line, also read the line for her thread on your Campaign Log:
  - **Unheard:** *Seraphine never learns what answered her that night. Some evenings she lays out the cards and waits, and nothing reaches back.*
  - **Suspected:** *Seraphine copies every name from the town's ledger into a notebook. Hers is not among them. She reads the list every night anyway, looking for the one that should have been hers.*
  - **Known:** *Seraphine never says the name aloud. But she sets a second cup at the table each night, and some mornings it has been drunk.*
- If **Elias Warde** has an epilogue line, also read: *Elias does not take the train. He walks the Sunken Road out to the point, climbs the stair he has climbed for thirty-one years, and lights the lamp in broad daylight, for no ship at all. The keeper's book stays on its shelf. He does not open it.*
- If **Dr. Ayako Sōma** has an epilogue line, also read: *Ayako fills a fifth notebook on the train and stops halfway down a page. She has translated everything the night said but one word, and she leaves that one in the language it was written in.*
- If **Cass Lindqvist** has an epilogue line, also read: *Cass deals a hand face up on the seat beside her and watches it a long while. Nobody else is counting now. For the first time since Ambergrove, she can see the whole table.*
- If **"Birdie" Okonkwo** has an epilogue line, also read: *At the station Birdie's compass swings once, wavers, and settles on north for the first time in its life. She looks at it for a long time. Then she takes the road anyway.*
- If **Those Who Left the Loop** names anyone who aged out before the finale, also read once: *On the shore road the walkers have stopped. In the first light they push back their hoods, one by one, like people at the end of a long shift. One of them is someone you know. They do not look up as the train goes by, but they are smiling.*

Appendix – Starting Decks

Suggestions only: build your own deck if you prefer. Each list is a legal **30-card starting deck** of level 0 cards, checked against the investigator's deckbuilding options, the 2-copy limit and any per-deck limits. The cards listed on the back of the investigator card and 1 random basic weakness are added as usual and do not count toward the 30. Every card is an official Arkham Horror: The Card Game card in SCED's player cards; if one is missing from your copy, swap it for another level 0 card of the same class and a similar cost.

Elias Warde (Guardian). *Guardian cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 Survivor cards (level 0–2).* 2 Beat Cop, 2 First Aid, 2 Machete, 2 Medical Student, 2 Physical Training, 2 Survival Knife, 1 Improvised Shield, 2 "Get behind me!", 2 Dodge, 2 Evidence!, 1 Heroic Rescue, 2 Emergency Cache, 2 Improvised Weapon, 2 Scrounge for Supplies, 2 Vicious Blow, 2 Guts.

Dr. Ayako Sōma (Seeker). *Seeker cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 Mystic cards (level 0–2).* 2 Art Student, 2 Dr. Milan Christopher — Professor of Entomology, 2 Hyperawareness, 2 Magnifying Glass, 2 Research Librarian, 2 Holy Rosary, 2 Burning the Midnight Oil, 2 Mind over Matter, 2 Working a Hunch, 1 Emergency Cache, 2 Read the Signs, 1 Ward of Protection, 2 Deduction, 1 Eureka!, 2 Guts, 2 Perception, 1 Unexpected Courage.

Cass Lindqvist (Rogue). *Rogue cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 cards of any other class (level 0).* 2 Burglary, 2 Lockpicks, 2 Pickpocketing, 2 Silver Tongue, 2 Stealth, 1 Sticky Fingers, 2 Holy Rosary, 1 Backstab, 2 Elusive, 2 Sneak Attack, 2 Sneak By, 2 Dodge, 2 Emergency Cache, 1 Ward of Protection, 2 Cunning, 1 Opportunist, 2 Guts.

"Birdie" Okonkwo (Survivor). *Survivor cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 other Guardian, Mystic, Rogue and/or Seeker cards (level 0–1).* 2 Dig Deep, 1 Hunter's Instinct, 2 Leather Coat, 2 Stray Cat, 1 Flashlight, 2 Knife, 2 Live and Learn, 2 "Look what I found!", 2 Lucky!, 2 Scrounge for Supplies, 2 Emergency Cache, 1 Dodge, 1 Elusive, 2 Working a Hunch, 2 Survival Instinct, 2 Take Heart, 2 Guts.

Seraphine Vale (Mystic). *Mystic cards, Neutral cards, up to 5 Seeker cards (level 0–2).* 2 Arcane Studies, 1 Clarity of Mind, 2 Jim Culver — Haunted Musician, 2 Rite of Seeking, 2 Shrivelling, 2 Magnifying Glass, 2 Blinding Light, 1 Meditative Trance, 2 Ward of Protection, 2 Emergency Cache, 2 Working a Hunch, 2 Defiance, 2 Fearless, 2 Guts, 1 Perception, 2 Unexpected Courage, 1 Deduction.

Appendix – Encounter Deck Contents

You never need this with the boxes: **Place** builds every deck. Use it to build the decks by hand, or to check a box.

Set	Cards (copies)	Used in
The Occultation	Lost Hour (3), Slippage (2)	Prologue, every loop
Echoes of Ambergrove	The Waiting Congregation (2), The Drowned Choir (2), Familiar Face (1), The Lamplighter's Echo (1)	Prologue, every loop
Strays of the Night	The Minute Hand (1)	Prologue, every loop
Static	Wrong Turn (1), Stutter (1), Dead Air (1), The Loop Notices You (1)	Prologue, every loop
The Weight of Years	A Year in a Night (2), What You've Forgotten (2), Old Bones (1)	Prologue, every loop
The Appointed	The Appointed's Whisper (2)	every loop from Part II; The Appointed is set aside, and The Appointed's Approach goes into play beside the Hours
District sets	as each district's entry lists (the Drowned Church's adds a third copy of The Drowned Choir, and the Sunken Road's a third copy of The Waiting Congregation)	when that district is placed

Every scenario card prints its set's symbol. A district's locations, acts and story assets print its district's symbol (The Square, The Lighthouse, The Drowned Church, The Sunken Road, The Fairground, The Almanac House); the Hours, the Prologue's cards and the story cards print ; the Named print ; The Last Hour's cards print .

The Prologue's deck is the first five sets (21 cards). A loop's deck is those five sets plus the Square's (25 cards), plus each placed district's set, plus, from Part II, the Whispers and the Fairground's new enemy (when the Fairground is placed).

The Still Hour — Campaign Log

Fill in at each interlude. Everything on this sheet persists across resets.

Campaign started: _____ **Difficulty:** ☐ Easy ☐ Standard ☐ Hard ☐ Expert

Loop Counter

Completed loops ◯ *Scar next loop (= loops; max 4/4/6/8 at 1–4 inv.):* ◯ **Investigators:** ◯

Current Part: ☐ I — Learning the Rules ☐ II — The Shape of the Hour ☐ The Last Hour available

Investigators

Investigator 1

Name _____

Class _____ **Player** _____

Years ◯ ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 · Weathered 5–9 · Elder 10–14 · Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ –1 ☐ –1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Quest ◯ ☐ met: swap the quest card

Recollections _____

_____

☐ Aged out **Finale:** _____

Investigator 2

Name _____

Class _____ **Player** _____

Years ◯ ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 · Weathered 5–9 · Elder 10–14 · Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ –1 ☐ –1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Quest ◯ ☐ met: swap the quest card

Recollections _____

_____

☐ Aged out **Finale:** _____

Investigator 3

Name _____

Class _____ **Player** _____

Years ◯ ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 · Weathered 5–9 · Elder 10–14 · Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ –1 ☐ –1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Quest ◯ ☐ met: swap the quest card

Recollections _____

_____

☐ Aged out **Finale:** _____

Investigator 4

Name _____

Class _____ **Player** _____

Years ◯ ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 · Weathered 5–9 · Elder 10–14 · Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ –1 ☐ –1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Quest ◯ ☐ met: swap the quest card

Recollections _____

_____

☐ Aged out **Finale:** _____

Banked Memory

Banked Memory ◯ *(cap 10 × investigators after spending; never below 0)* **Spent this interlude** ◯

Spent on: _____

Campaign Notes

_____

_____

The Knowledge Track

When the guide says to record an entry, tick its row (or write its name on the line). It lasts through every reset.

The first time you record an entry, each investigator gains banked Memory: 1 for a surface entry, 3 for a deep entry.

- ☐ **Prologue** _____
- ☐ **Lighthouse — surface** _____
- ☐ **Lighthouse — deep** _____
- ☐ **Church — surface** _____
- ☐ **Church — deep** _____
- ☐ **Sunken Road — surface** _____
- ☐ **Sunken Road — deep** _____
- ☐ **Square — surface** _____
- ☐ **Square — deep** _____
- ☐ **Fairground — surface** _____
- ☐ **Fairground — deep** _____
- ☐ **Almanac — surface** _____
- ☐ **Almanac — deep** _____
- ☐ **Assembled** _____

Surface entries recorded: ◯ */ 6 · Part II: 3+ or Loop 3* **Deep entries recorded:** ◯ */ 6*

Before the Last Hour

- ☐ **Lighthouse** _____
- ☐ **Sunken Road** _____
- ☐ **Fairground** _____
- ☐ **Church** _____
- ☐ **Square** _____
- ☐ **Almanac** _____

All six recorded: the next loop is the finale (The Night Will Not Wait).

Victory

		claimed	*Memory banked*
Church — Named (Victory 2)	_____	☐	☐
Square — Named (Victory 3)	_____	☐	☐
Fairground — Named (Victory 2)	_____	☐	☐
Church — monster (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Sunken Road — monster (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Almanac — monster (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Lighthouse — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Church — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Square — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Fairground — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐
Almanac — location (Victory 1)	_____	☐	☐

Threads

Seraphine's thread: ☐ unheard ☐ suspected ☐ known

Those Who Left the Loop

Investigator	*Fate*	*Loop*
_____	☐ aged out ☐ kept as anchor	_____
_____	☐ aged out ☐ kept as anchor	_____
_____	☐ aged out ☐ kept as anchor	_____
_____	☐ aged out ☐ kept as anchor	_____

Choices

Prologue ended: ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ The First Death

Loops ended: Torn ◯ **Taken** ◯ **Closed at the Hour** ◯

Prologue ☐ 1st _____ ☐ 2nd _____

The Lighthouse ☐ 1st _____ ☐ 2nd _____

The Drowned Church ☐ 1st _____ ☐ 2nd _____

Standing rule (1st): _____

Standing rule (2nd): _____

The Sunken Road ☐ 1st _____ ☐ 2nd _____

Standing rule (2nd): _____

The Square ☐ 1st _____ ☐ 2nd _____

The Fairground ☐ 1st _____ ☐ 2nd _____

Standing rule (2nd): _____

The Almanac House ☐ 1st _____ ☐ 2nd _____

Name (Lighthouse): _____

Finale Record

Attempted on loop: _____ **As It Is defeated:** ☐ yes ☐ no **Banked Memory:** ◯

Resolution reached:

☐ R1 ☐ R1b ☐ R2 ☐ R3 ☐ R4 ☐ R5 ☐ R6 ☐ R7 ☐ R8

Deep entries spent this finale: _____

How the night ended: _____

Years paid at the end: _____

Campaign Notes

_____

_____